Lautaro Agustín Montoya

Game Designer — Systems & Mechanics · Unity / C#

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Portfolio: montoyalautaroportfolio.netlify.app · Play Keep It Alive: pehuamann.itch.io/keep-it-alive

PROFILE

Systems-focused game designer who designs and builds his own games end to end. Currently developing **Keep It Alive**, a turn-based roguelite deckbuilder about protecting a hospitalized loved one, now in public early access on itch.io, alongside five other original prototypes and concepts in my portfolio. I prototype in Unity and C#, structure content as data, and tune balance with automated simulations and playtesting. Five years in travel and customer operations taught me to make decisions under pressure and to communicate clearly across teams. Looking for a **Junior Game Designer** or **Systems Designer** role.

FEATURED PROJECT

Keep It Alive — Solo Designer & Developer — Early access on itch.io

Design and direction · Unity, C#, ScriptableObjects

A single-player, turn-based roguelite deckbuilder in pixel art. The player protects a hospitalized loved one, their Ward, through day-by-day card battles against the hardships of a hospital stay, ending face to face with Death. Design goal: turn exhaustion into a system that changes decisions, not a flat penalty.

- **Enemies that attack the player's hand:** Fever burns cards, Depression soaks and disables them, and other threats trap, mutate or erase cards, so each enemy changes what the player can do, not just how much damage they take.
- **Escalating resource chain:** 3 Energy and 5 cards per turn; Overexertion lets the player play cards without enough Energy, paying the missing cost as double Fatigue. Fatigue (0–10) adds status cards to the deck at each level and ends in Collapse (one card per turn), and it carries over between fights.
- **Two health pools, two kinds of protection:** player and Ward HP persist between encounters and the run ends if either reaches 0; Stabilization shields the Ward persistently, while Containment protects the player only temporarily.
- **Run structure:** a branching path with four node types (regular days, harder days with better rewards, shops where cards cost the player's own HP, and rest nights), 8 common enemies, 5 bosses that each transform the room, and a final encounter with Death that cannot be won by dealing damage.
- **Content at scale:** 108 player cards and 52 enemy and status cards, all defined in data tables, so content is designed and rebalanced without touching code.
- **Balance by simulation:** built a headless rules engine where bots with different play styles run thousands of full runs (5,000 per balance pass) and report win rate against a 20–35% target, boss clear rates and causes of death; 122 automated tests guard the rules.
- **Iterating from feedback:** a playtest showed a common enemy hitting harder than a boss; the simulation confirmed one card (*Code Blue*) was the #1 cause of death (13.7%). I removed it from that enemy's deck and set the rule "a common enemy can never be more dangerous than a boss"; win rate went from 27% to 36%.
- **Built for replayability:** three difficulty levels (measured at 67% / 40% / 17% win rate), cards unlocked by reaching Death, and full mouse, keyboard and gamepad support.
- Owned design and implementation end to end in Unity and C#: gameplay systems, card data, UI built from editable prefabs, enemy mechanics, and every decision logged in a design record.

OTHER PROJECTS

Junkborn — Eco de Chatarra — Playable prototype · Unity

Roguelite systems prototype. The player builds a robot from 5 component slots whose parts degrade in combat, trading power against durability. Built to test whether equipment degradation produces improvisation rather than punishment; the prototype tracks turns survived, enemies defeated and components broken.

Blood Debt (Deuda de Sangre)

Strategic card game · In development

The player judges souls as the tollkeeper of a spiritual bridge; systems such as Burden Points and Earthly Anchor tie each soul's story to gameplay consequences and corruption.

Design concepts

Case studies in the portfolio

Grey Market (systemic economy sim driven by information spread), Shift Protocol (3D puzzle about unstable reality states) and Last Breath (turn-based survival where oxygen is the tactical currency).

SKILLS

Game design	Systems design, core loops, resource and economy design, card and deckbuilding design, run structure and progression, boss and encounter design, balancing, risk/reward mechanics, player-state systems, rapid prototyping, playtesting and iteration, design documentation.
Technical	Unity, C#, data-driven design (data tables, ScriptableObjects), automated balance simulation and testing, Git / GitHub.
Professional	Clear written communication, stakeholder coordination, decision-making under pressure, organization across many parallel tasks.

EXPERIENCE

Travel Coordinator — Newfly

Córdoba, Argentina · 2024 – present

- Coordinate logistics for individual and group travelers, handling many concurrent cases with airlines, hotels and local operators.
- Resolve cancellations and last-minute changes fast, choosing between options with incomplete information and tight deadlines.
- Keep every party aligned through clear written updates, so clients, suppliers and colleagues act on the same plan.

Customer Service Roles — KMB, Eilat, Distraction Good Tourism, Konecta

2021 – 2023

- Supported customers in Spanish, English and Portuguese across tourism and contact-center operations.

EDUCATION & LEARNING

Self-directed game development

1–2 years

Unity, C# gameplay programming, data-driven architecture, automated testing and simulation, Git workflow; applied directly in Keep It Alive.

LANGUAGES

Spanish (native) · English (fluent) · Portuguese (fluent) · German (learning)